

Open Knowledge, No Secret Enclosure

An S.V.E. Manifesto for Symmetric Knowledge and Copyright Reform

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Final candidate for signature

The worker deserves his wages. — Luke 10:7; 1 Timothy 5:18
Live by your skills and talents — not by your secrets.

Declaration

Human knowledge is cumulative. Every modern algorithm stands on languages, mathematics, observations, failures, and insights contributed across generations and civilizations. No laboratory, corporation, state, or individual created that inheritance alone.

Yet contemporary intellectual-property law contains a structural asymmetry. Humanity's accumulated ideas, mathematical principles, scientific methods, and public research may be taken as inputs. A private actor may then surround the resulting implementation with copyright, patents, contracts, infrastructure control, and trade secrecy — and return almost nothing to the common inheritance from which it grew.

The law often protects the final enclosure more strongly than the open intellectual root.

This Manifesto rejects that asymmetry as a model for the future.

I. The Author's Will

I state my will as Author clearly:

Everything that is legally mine to license within the S.V.E. Corpus is offered to Humanity on the condition of reciprocal openness. I do not intend my works to become raw material for a closed monopoly. I do not consent to a system in which the visible fragment remains open while the operative derivative, model, ontology, algorithmic implementation, evidence base, or service layer disappears behind secrecy.

Where copyright reaches, I exercise it for openness. Where contract can lawfully attach through informed assent, I require openness. Where database or patent rights exist, I exercise them against enclosure. Where the law leaves ideas and methods free, I use defensive publication, provenance, open standards, reference implementations, and public accountability so that no later actor can plausibly erase the common root or claim it as a private invention.

I do not claim ownership of truth, mathematics, or thought itself. I claim the right to determine the lawful terms on which my own expression, code, models, datasets, architecture, and other protected contributions are used — and I record the moral purpose for which they were released.

That purpose is indivisible: what is received openly must not be returned to Humanity as a secret.

II. Commerce Is Welcome; Enclosure Is Not

S.V.E. is not anti-business. It is anti-enclosure.

A master should be rewarded for honest work. People may charge for building, hosting, maintaining, teaching, integrating, certifying, supporting, improving, and responsibly operating S.V.E.-based systems. They may sell products and services, use subscriptions, receive recurring payments, and earn as much as freely consenting users will pay, subject to the applicable S.V.E. terms.

The price is not the problem. The secret wall is.

Payment should reward labor, skill, reliability, courage, and service. It should not purchase the right to hide the very knowledge that made the product possible.

Earn as much as you can — openly.

III. The All-or-Nothing Principle

Openness is not satisfied by publishing a ceremonial repository while the real system remains closed.

If an S.V.E.-based product depends materially on hidden code, undisclosed weights, secret ontologies, invisible prompts, private orchestration, unavailable data provenance, suppressed evaluations, or remote components placed beyond the disclosure boundary, then the system is not open.

There must be no secret module, no hidden wrapper, no closed remainder, and no corporate or contractual shell used to move the essential logic out of view.

This is the One-Bit Principle: deliberate concealment of even one material bit required to understand, reproduce, audit, or verify the system violates the unity of the open grant. Materiality matters; trivial differences do not. Honest mistakes may be corrected. Deliberate concealment may not be reclassified as error after discovery.

IV. Science Must Remember Its Failures

Open science that publishes only success is not fully open.

Negative results, failed replications, limitations, null findings, abandoned paths, and uncertainty are part of the scientific record. Suppressing them wastes the labor of future researchers, distorts evidence, rewards exaggeration, and makes harmful systems harder to audit.

Under the S.V.E. principle:

- honest error is permitted;
- failed work is permitted;
- changing one's mind in light of evidence is permitted;
- fabrication is not permitted;
- selective concealment is not permitted;
- intentionally irreproducible claims are not permitted.

Mistakes belong in the record. Lies do not belong in science.

V. Privacy Is Not Enclosure

Radical openness must not become an excuse to expose the vulnerable.

Personal data, confidential sources, credentials, legally privileged communications, medical information, and facts whose publication would create a concrete danger may be protected. But the exception must remain narrow. It may protect a person; it may not protect an enclosing business model.

Where information must be redacted, the existence, reason, scope, and expected duration of the redaction should be disclosed, together with a reproducible substitute wherever possible.

The test is simple: does the secrecy protect a human being from harm, or does it protect power from accountability?

VI. Accountability Must Be Reciprocal

No one should weaponize transparency against others while remaining opaque themselves.

When a party raises a documented suspicion of bad faith, concealment, or fabrication, it should accept equivalent scrutiny on the same subject first or simultaneously. Audit must be proportionate, evidence-based, privacy-preserving, and protected against harassment or competitive extraction.

The one who demands a glass house must be willing to stand in one.

VII. What Present Law Can and Cannot Do

Copyright ordinarily protects expression, not bare ideas, procedures, methods of operation, or mathematical concepts as such. A license cannot honestly promise more than the law allows. No sentence in a private document can turn a mathematical truth into private property merely by declaring it so.

But this limit does not make the S.V.E. project futile.

The law can still protect concrete text, code, architecture expressed in protectable form, models, selected or arranged data, documentation, and other original artifacts. Network copyleft can require source availability for covered server software. Share-alike licensing can keep covered non-software adaptations open. Database rights, patent non-aggression, text-and-data-mining reservations, provenance, timestamps, reference implementations, and contractual commitments may add further layers.

Defensive publication also matters: even where an idea itself remains free, a timestamped public disclosure can preserve priority, resist later enclosure by patents where the applicable rules allow, and ensure that Humanity retains an open route to independent implementation.

Legal realism is not surrender. It is the discipline of using every valid instrument without confusing aspiration with an already existing right.

VIII. A Proposal for Copyright and Knowledge-Commons Reform

The next generation of law should recognize a voluntary Knowledge Commons Integrity Right. An author who openly designates a work, method, or research program as part of a protected commons should be able to require that materially dependent commercial implementations preserve reciprocal access to the knowledge necessary for public understanding, reproduction, and audit.

Such reform should include:

1. A registered commons designation. Authors could record a timestamped, machine-readable declaration that their contribution is released only for non-enclosing use.
2. A material-dependency test. Liability would require more than thematic similarity: documented access plus substantial structural dependence, incorporation, training use, or reliance on distinctive protected material.
3. A rebuttable provenance duty. A commercial actor with documented access and a materially similar closed system would maintain contemporaneous development records sufficient to support a claim of genuine independent creation.

4. A network-use right. Public operation of materially dependent software or models as a service would trigger disclosure duties equivalent to distribution.
5. A whole-system rule. Disclosure would cover the material integrated system, preventing evasion through wrappers, APIs, affiliates, contractors, or remote modules.
6. Protected openness for models and ontologies. The law would recognize that weights, prompts, schemas, ontologies, evaluation protocols, and material training provenance may be as operationally important as conventional source code.
7. Mandatory publication of material negative evidence. A party making scientific, safety, or performance claims from a commons-derived research program would disclose material failed and null results, subject to proportionate privacy and safety protections.
8. Commercial freedom. Compliance would impose no general price ceiling. Firms could compete and profit through quality, labor, service, speed, reliability, and trust — not through secret capture of the common root.
9. Privacy and safety safeguards. The law would protect people, confidential sources, credentials, and genuinely dangerous technical details while requiring narrow tailoring, accountable redaction, and eventual disclosure where the danger passes.
10. No retroactive confiscation. Reform would operate prospectively, respect vested rights and lawful exceptions, and distinguish enforceable legal duties from moral criticism.
11. Public-interest enforcement. Authors, users, qualified public-interest bodies, and regulators would have proportionate standing to seek disclosure, correction, attribution, and injunctions against enclosure.
12. Safe harbor for honest compliance. Prompt correction, complete disclosure, and good-faith recordkeeping would protect honest builders from disproportionate penalties; deliberate concealment and fabrication would receive no such shelter.

This reform would not prohibit invention or enterprise. It would change the object of competition: from who can hide the most to who can serve Humanity best.

IX. The S.V.E. Covenant

To builders, researchers, companies, and institutions:

Take these works. Study them. Improve them. Test them. Disprove them where they are wrong. Build useful products. Charge for your labor. Create durable enterprises. Earn well.

But do not take what was given openly and return it as a secret.

Do not publish only the success and bury the failure.

Do not demand transparency from others while refusing it yourself.

Do not confuse possession of infrastructure with ownership of Humanity's intellectual inheritance.

Your honest mistake can be forgiven and corrected. Your negative result can become a gift to the next researcher. Your profit can be honorable. Your secrecy over the common root cannot be the foundation of the bargain.

X. Closing

This Manifesto distinguishes moral judgment from legal enforceability. Courts decide the reach of existing positive law. They do not exhaust the question of what the law ought to become.

I use the rights that present law gives me without declaring present law morally complete. I call for its reform where it permits a one-way transfer from the common inheritance of Humanity into permanent private enclosure.

The principle is neither anti-market nor anti-technology:

Reward the worker. Preserve the commons. Audit power. Publish the failures. Permit no secret enclosure of what was received openly.

Live by your skills and talents — not by your secrets.

Signature

To be signed — AK1984 — Dr. Artiom A. Kovnatsky (The Revizor)

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By their fruits you will know them. — Matthew 7:20